

RAJWANT RAWAT

ANURADHA JANGRA, 25

PhD student, JNU

Lok Sabha constituency: Bhiwani-Mahendragarh, Haryana

Top 3 demands: Rise in household income, industrial development, robust diplomacy

What will influence her vote: Economic growth, local issues, candidates

women in various fields. The Modi government's focus on women's issues is significant enough to sway opinions, including my own," she explains. Another factor is foreign policy. "India's diplomatic reach has grown. More than before, India now has the capacity to make a meaningful impact in global affairs," she says. One highlight was the G20 presidency, especially the New Delhi Consensus. "All major economies agreed to it. But India's growing profile carries consequences in terms of the cost of being popular and important," she says. ■

"What appeals to me is things like increased participation of women in varied fields under the Modi regime"

–Sonali Acharjee

Working Solution

Sarvjeet's dream was always to get into the paramilitary CRPF, but it came to nought in 2022 when the government introduced the Agnipath scheme under which recruits would be hired only for a four-year period. He completed his graduation last year and is still preparing for exams related to the defence services in the hope that he will get through in one of them. "Jobs in the public sector (including defence) are few these days but we have to prepare ourselves to take the limited opportunities. I belong to the weaker section of society, so we have few choices. I have to crack the exams...the only other option is farming." Sarvjeet will be casting his vote for the first time this election. He does not believe in caste or religious discrimination and the new Ram temple is also not a big issue for him. Angry with the unemployment scenario and the politics of polarisation, he says he'll vote for a change. ■

–Prashant Srivastava



SUMIT KUMAR

SARVJEET, 22

Government job aspirant

Lok Sabha constituency: Kheri, UP

Top 3 demands

More government jobs, technical training for rural students, free coaching for weaker sections

L.R. BHARATH, 28

Entrepreneur from Vijayawada, Andhra Pradesh

Lok Sabha constituency: Gautam Buddha Nagar, UP

Top 3 demands: Economic growth, rural infrastructure development and freedom of speech

"If I don't find a suitable choice among the candidates, I might opt for NOTA"



CHANDRADEEP KUMAR

be economic growth, infrastructure development, especially in rural areas, and safeguarding freedom of speech. As for his vote, he remarks, "If I don't find a suitable choice among the candidates, I might opt for NOTA (none of the above)."

Bharath likes to stay informed about political affairs, does not rely on any particular news channel but always engages in discussions about politics with the people that he encounters. "I interact with people from all walks of life, from labourers to jewellers to merchants, so I get an on-the-ground perspective," he says. ■

–Sonal Khetarpal